

Some time between 26 and 30 weeks your blood will be tested to check that you aren't anemic. If you are found to be anemic your doctor may prescribe iron pills for you. Because of an increase in the fluid content of your blood, your hemoglobin count is likely to fall later on in your pregnancy, so it's a good idea to address this issue now.

Iron pills can cause digestive problems, such as constipation or diarrhea, so if this happens to you, ask your doctor if your prescription can be changed. The liquid medications available over the counter are kinder on the digestive system than pills, so ask your doctor if one of these is appropriate for you.

If a previous blood test has shown that you're Rh negative, you'll receive an injection of Rh immunoglobulin (RhIg) at around 28–34 weeks. You'll get another shot after the baby is born.